

Enterprise Architecture & Risk Assessment Exercise

Objective

Design a scalable, secure, and highly available enterprise application on Google Cloud, considering the provincial infrastructure in the Philippines and specific architectural choices.

Background Scenario

You are the Lead Cloud Architect for "**AgriConnect**", a platform that allows farmers to access market prices, apply for micro-loans, and sell produce directly to distributors.

User Profile & Constraints:

- **Tech Stack:** React Native (Mobile), Next.js (Web Frontend), and Nest.js (Backend API).
- **Geographic Distribution:** Users are highly concentrated across provincial Philippines (Luzon, Visayas, Mindanao).
- **Infrastructure Challenge:** Provincial internet connectivity can be intermittent and have high latency to major data centers.
- **Compliance/Security:** PII and financial data must be encrypted and protected under strict data privacy laws.

Task 1: Software Architecture Diagram

Provide a high-level architecture diagram. Clearly label:

- **Global Edge & Load Balancing:** How users access the system.
- **Compute Tier:** Deployment strategy for Next.js and Nest.js.
- **Data Tier:** The storage and database services.
- **Integration Points:** CDN, asset delivery, and real-time components (chat/live maps).

Task 2: Architectural Justification

For each component in your diagram, provide a 2–3 sentence explanation focusing on:

1. **Multizone High Availability:** How the architecture tolerates a zone or regional outage.
2. **Provincial Latency Optimization:** How you minimize loading times given the local network constraints.
3. **Budget Optimization:** How the architecture minimizes operating costs without sacrificing availability.

Task 3: Security & Compliance

1. **DDoS and OWASP Mitigation:** How you protect external endpoints.
2. **Data Protection:** How you secure data in transit and at rest, implementing the principle of least privilege.

Task 4: Monitoring, Logging, and Alerting

1. Explain how you will observe system health and security breaches using GCP services.
2. Define **two specific thresholds/metrics** that will trigger automatic alerts and notifications to the engineering team.

Task 5: Risk Assessment & Mitigation Matrix

Fill out the matrix below:

Risk Category	Specific Risk Description	Likelihood (High/Med/Low)	Impact (High/Med/Low)	Mitigation Strategy on GCP
Connectivity	High latency for provincial users during peak hours.			
Availability	Zonal infrastructure failure affecting operations.			
Security	Data breach of PII in transit or at rest.			
Budget	Unexpected scaling costs from sudden traffic spikes.			